

Nicholas Forster-Benson

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<https://nfb77.github.io/>

Education

2025 - Pres.	Ph.D. Sociology & Social Policy, Harvard University, Cambridge, Massachusetts
2021 - 2025	B.A. Economics; Quantitative Social Science, Vanderbilt University, Nashville, Tennessee <i>magna cum laude</i> , highest honors (economics) visiting student, Università Bocconi, Milano, Lombardia

Research Interests

Political economy	Organizational and economic sociology
Markets and inequality	Quantitative methods

Publications

2025	N. Forster-Benson and K. Nchare. " Upzoning and Residential Transaction Price in Nashville ." <i>Journal of Housing Economics</i> , 70: 102104.
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Works in Progress

- N. Forster-Benson. "[Corporate Ownership Density and Rent in the United States: An Analysis from 2012-2022](#)." Working paper.
- N. Forster-Benson. "Upzoning, Density, and the Financialization of Space in Nashville." Under Review.
- N. Forster-Benson. "Towards a Relational Understanding of Zoning Conflict." In Preparation.
- N. Forster-Benson and K. Nchare. "[Trade Distortions and Colonial Legacy: Evidence from Portugal and Its Former Colonies](#)." Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of International Development*.

Grants and Fellowships

<i>External:</i>	
2026	Housing Case Studies Grant (with Karim Nchare), Social Science Research Council (SSRC), Better Urbanism, Infrastructure, and Land-Use Decisions (BUILD) Program, \$10,000
<i>Internal:</i>	
2026	Malcolm Hewitt Wiener PhD Scholar in Poverty and Justice, Stone Program in Wealth Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy, Harvard Kennedy School, \$44,000
2026	Graduate Seed Grant, Center for American Political Studies at Harvard University, \$1,000
2024	John J. Siegfried Honors Economics Scholars Student Research Grant, \$2,000
2023	Humanities in the Real-World Fellow, Robert Penn Warren Center, \$1,000
2023	Vanderbilt Undergraduate Summer Research Program, \$7,100

Teaching

	<i>Department of Economics, Vanderbilt University:</i>
Fall 2024	Economic Statistics (ECON 1500), Teaching Assistant, Syllabus
	<i>Department of Sociology, Vanderbilt University:</i>
Fall 2022, 2023	Contemporary American Society (SOC 3233), Teaching Assistant, Syllabus
Fall 2023	Cultural Production and Institutions (SOC 3202), Teaching Assistant, Syllabus

Research

2023 - 2025	Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Vanderbilt University <i>Advisor: Dr. Karim Nchare</i>
2023	Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Vanderbilt University <i>Advisor: Dr. Richard Lloyd</i>
2023	Research Assistant, Lab. for Research on Conflict and Collective Action <i>Advisor: Dr. Andrew Coe</i>

Non-Academic Employment

2026 - Pres.	Graduate Resident Advisor, Harvard Graduate School of Arts and Sciences
2022 - 2025	Resident Advisor, V. U. Office of Housing and Residential Experience
2024	Candidate, Tennessee State House District 56
2023	Intern, U.S. Federal Reserve Board
2022	Intern, Tennessee Department of Treasury

Affiliation

2025 - Pres.	Graduate affiliate, Center for American Political Studies, Harvard University
2025 - Pres.	Graduate affiliate, Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University
2025 - Pres.	Member, American Sociological Association
2023 - Pres.	Member, American Planning Association

Programming Languages

L^AT_EX, Python, QGIS, R, Stata